

IdeaScope AI

Derived from the Startup Validation Report — 20 July 2026

Idea	AI platform generating market research, competitor analysis, SWOT, pricing suggestions & MVP recommendations from a submitted startup idea
Problem	First-time founders spend weeks manually researching whether an idea is worth pursuing
Target customers	Student entrepreneurs, startup founders, incubators, hackathon participants
Competitors	Preuve AI, IdeaProof, DimeADozen.AI, ValidatorAI, WorthBuild, IdeaBuddy, FounderPal, User Intuition/Wynter/Maze
Validation insight	No users/waitlist/pilots yet. Market is saturated (12+ live tools). FMF score 5.4/10. Verdict: Conditional Go — narrow to institutional cohort wedge.

Executive Summary

IdeaScope AI solves a real, well-documented problem, but the direct "submit idea → get AI report" wedge is now commoditized by 12+ live competitors. This blueprint reframes the MVP around the most defensible, least-served customer: incubator and hackathon program managers who need to batch-validate 15–100 team ideas per cohort — not individual founders competing with free ChatGPT-based validation.

Ideal Customer Profile

Attribute	Primary ICP	Secondary ICP
Who	Incubator / entrepreneurship-cell program manager	Individual student founder / hackathon participant
Context	Runs 15-100 team cohort, needs standardized screening	Wants a fast idea sanity-check
Budget	Institutional, per-cohort	Own pocket, price-sensitive
Channel	Direct outreach, incubator networks, Devfolio/Unstop	LinkedIn, campus ambassadors

Buyer Persona — Priya, 29, Incubator Program Manager

Goal	Shortlist strongest ideas fairly & fast; show a rigorous process to funders/leadership
Frustration	Manually reviewing 40 decks is slow/inconsistent; teams submit ideas with no market evidence
Buys when	Tool gives a defensible, consistent scoring rubric she can hand every team
Churns when	Output feels like generic AI boilerplate, duplicating free ChatGPT use

Top 10 Customer Pain Points

- Unsure if an idea is worth months of time before committing
- Manually screening 15-100 team pitches per cohort is slow and inconsistent between reviewers
- AI feedback often feels generic/agreeable rather than evidence-backed
- Students have little to no budget for \$29-\$179 one-time reports
- No rubric-based format mentors/professors can defend to stakeholders
- Hard to compare ideas apples-to-apples across a cohort or hackathon batch
- No integration with existing hackathon/incubator judging workflows
- Weak guidance on pricing/monetization once an idea is validated
- Fear of wasting an entire semester or hackathon cycle on the wrong idea
- Limited access to real competitor/funding data without paid tools

Customer Journey

Awareness	Consideration	Purchase	Retention
Feels stuck; unsure idea is worth pursuing	Searches AI validators; asks mentors what tools exist	Institution buys cohort license; individual converts from free scan	Renews each semester/hackathon season

Key Objections	Key Buying Triggers
"ChatGPT already does this for free"	Cohort/hackathon deadline approaching
"Why not use Preuve AI / IdeaProof instead?"	A peer team's project just failed from no market demand
"We have no budget line for this"	Incubator needs a structured process to show funders
"AI validation isn't rigorous enough for our program"	

MVP Recommendation

Build first	A batch/cohort validation mode: bulk idea submission → comparable, source-linked reports → a judge/mentor dashboard for one pilot hackathon or incubator
Do NOT build	Brand/logo kits, full pitch-deck/financial-model generators, freeform chat validators — already commoditized by IdeaProof and DimeADozen.AI
Success metrics	1 signed pilot cohort; 70%+ team completion rate; 1 paying institutional customer; mentor NPS ≥ 40

MoSCoW Prioritization

Must Have	Should Have	Could Have	Won't Have (v1)
Batch cohort submission	Free individual scan tier	Curriculum/course integration	Brand/logo generation
Structured comparable report	Pricing-suggestion module	Cohort leaderboard	Financial model/pitch deck builder
Source-linked data citations	Exportable PDF report	Slack/Discord bot	Freeform chat validator
Mentor/judge dashboard			Multi-language support

Pricing Hypothesis

Per-cohort institutional license: **\$199-\$499 per cohort of 20-50 teams** (one-time or per-season), plus a capped free tier for individual founders (1 scan/month) to drive organic top-of-funnel awareness.

Top 5 Risks

Risk	Mitigation
Well-funded incumbents (Preuve AI, DimeADozen.AI) expand into this niche	Move fast on institutional relationships; incumbents are not built for cohort mode today
LLMs make DIY validation free and "good enough"	Differentiate on live sourcing + workflow integration, not raw AI quality
Unconfirmed willingness to pay from ICP	Run 15-20 pilot conversations before writing production code
Solo founder, no technical/GTM redundancy	Recruit an advisor or co-founder from the target community
Slow institutional sales cycles	Run a parallel low-touch individual funnel while deals mature

30-Day MVP Plan

Days	Focus	Actions
1-7	Discovery	Interview 10 founders, 5 hackathon organizers, 5 incubator managers
8-14	Sharpen wedge	Commit to institutional cohort ICP; write 1-page positioning doc
15-21	Smoke test	Landing page + waitlist; target 50+ signups or 5+ institutional talks
22-27	Thin MVP	Build batch-report generator for one 10-team cohort only
28-30	Pilot	Secure one real paid/unpaid pilot cohort using the thin MVP

Founder Action Sheet — Top 10 Next Actions

- Interview 5 incubator/entrepreneurship-cell managers this week
- Interview 5 hackathon organizers about their current screening process
- Map exactly what Preuve AI, IdeaProof, and DimeADozen.AI do NOT offer for cohorts
- Write a 1-page positioning doc naming the institutional wedge

- Build a single landing page for the cohort/institutional offer
- Drive 50+ waitlist signups via LinkedIn, Discord, campus outreach
- Design the comparable batch-report format (rubric + score + citations)
- Scope the thinnest MVP: 10-team batch mode only, no extras
- Secure one committed pilot cohort (hackathon, incubator, or course)
- Test a small paid component in the pilot to confirm willingness to pay

Scores (0-100)

Metric	Score	Why
Customer Clarity	55	ICP narrowed to institutions, but not yet confirmed via direct conversations
Problem Severity	78	~42% of startup failures trace to no market need — the pain is real and large
PMF Potential	45	Crowded category; PMF depends entirely on the institutional wedge being defensible
MVP Readiness	60	Founder has technical capability; MVP scope still needs narrowing and a pilot commitment

Final Verdict

■ PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

Real problem, real founder capability, but zero direct customer validation and a saturated generic wedge. The institutional cohort angle is promising on paper — the next 30 days must convert that into confirmed demand before further build investment.

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